PhotoMatrix

Admin Guide

Managing Photographers & Importing Photos

July 2026

This guide covers the full lifecycle of a photographer in PhotoMatrix: creating their profile, sending an invite so they can claim the profile and sign in, editing existing profiles, removing members, and importing photos from a public portfolio URL.

Photographer management and URL imports are done from the Manage page (/manage). Photographer profiles use the Photographer tab; portfolio imports use the Import tab.

1. Creating a Photographer Profile

1. Go to Manage !' Photographer tab.
2. Fill in the Create Photographer form at the top of the tab:

Field	Required	Notes
Photo (avatar)	No	Click the camera circle to upload a portrait. JPG, PNG, WebP, max 5 MB.
Name	Yes	The photographer's display name across the site.
Club membership	No	Tick the clubs they belong to. Optionally enter the year they joined each club.
Preferred themes	No	Tick themes they specialise in — shown on their public profile.
Biography	No	A short text shown on their profile page.
Email address	No	If provided, an invite email is sent automatically the moment the profile is saved (see section 2).

3. Click Create photographer.

If an email was entered, the invite is dispatched immediately — you do not need to take any further action. The email contains a one-time join link valid for 30 days.

2. Sending an Invite Email

An invite email contains a unique join link that is pre-linked to the photographer's profile. When the photographer opens the link and signs in (or creates an account), their new account is automatically connected to their profile — no manual linking required.

When creating a profile

Enter the photographer's email address in the optional Email address field before clicking Create photographer. The invite is sent as part of the create action.

From the photographer list (after creation)

Photographers who have not yet signed in show an amber "Not yet signed in" badge. Next to the badge is a Send invite button:

1. Click Send invite.
2. The dialog opens with the photographer's last-known email pre-filled (if an email was used before).
3. Adjust the email address if needed, then click Send invite.

The previous email is remembered automatically — you only need to retype it if you want to use a different address.

From the edit form

When editing an unclaimed photographer, an Email address field with a Send invite button appears inside the edit form, above the Save / Cancel buttons:

1. Enter or confirm the email address.
2. Click Send invite — this sends the invite immediately without saving (or discarding) any other edits you may have open.

3. Continue editing and click Save changes when done.

3. The Invite & Claim Flow (What the Photographer Sees)

1. The photographer receives an email with a Join PhotoMatrix link.
2. They click the link and are taken to a sign-in / sign-up page.
3. After signing in (Google, email, or passkey), they see a "Claim my profile" screen showing their pre-built profile (name, avatar, clubs).
4. They click Claim my profile — their account is linked in one click.
5. They are redirected to their My Photos page, fully set up.

No manual searching or profile selection is needed. The invite token is single-use and expires after 30 days.

4. Tracking Who Has Signed In

The photographer list shows a status badge next to each name:

Badge	Meaning
Active (green)	The photographer has signed in and claimed their profile.
Not yet signed in (amber)	The profile exists but no account has been linked yet.

Claimed photographers hide the Send invite button — they already have an account and do not need one.

5. Re-sending an Invite

If a photographer did not receive their invite, lost the link, or the 30-day link expired:

1. Find them in the Photographer list.
2. Click Send invite next to the "Not yet signed in" badge.
3. Their previously used email is pre-filled in the dialog.
4. Click Send invite to issue a fresh link.

Each send creates a new token, so previous links are not invalidated automatically — but since each token is single-use, only the first redemption counts.

6. Editing a Photographer Profile

Click the Edit (pencil) button next to any photographer in the list. The form at the top of the tab switches to edit mode.

You can change:

- Avatar
- Name
- Club memberships and join years
- Preferred themes
- Biography

For unclaimed photographers, an additional Email address field with a Send invite button is shown — use it to send or resend an invite without leaving the edit form.

Click Save changes to apply edits, or Cancel to discard them.

> *Note: Editing a claimed photographer's name here changes their display name on PhotoMatrix but does not affect their sign-in credentials (managed by Clerk).*

7. Removing a Photographer

Click the Delete (bin) button next to a photographer in the list.

- All photos uploaded by that photographer are deleted first.
- If the photographer has a linked account and a removal reason is provided, a notification email is sent to them automatically before deletion.
- The action is permanent and cannot be undone.

8. Importing Photos from a URL

The Import tab lets you pull photos from any public photographer portfolio page and add them to PhotoMatrix in four steps — without ever leaving the browser.

8.1 Opening the Import Tab

1. Sign in as an admin and navigate to Manage (/manage).
2. Select the Import tab in the top navigation row.

8.2 Step 1 — Enter a URL and Choose Storage Mode

Field	What to do
Portfolio URL	Paste the full URL of the photographer's portfolio or gallery page (e.g. https://janedoe.photography/gallery).
Storage mode	Choose how images are stored (see below).

Storage modes

Download & store (recommended)

The server downloads each selected image and saves it in PhotoMatrix's own object storage. Photos remain available even if the original website changes or disappears.

Link only

Records are created that point back to the original image URL. No storage is used, but photos will break if the source removes them.

Click Scan for Photos when ready. The server fetches the page and extracts every <img> element. Large pages may take a few seconds.

> *Note: Password-protected pages, pages that require JavaScript rendering, or sites that block bots may not scan successfully. If the scan returns no photos, check that the URL is publicly accessible.*

8.3 Step 2 — Select Photos

After a successful scan, a thumbnail grid appears showing every image found on the page.

- Click a thumbnail (or its checkbox) to select / deselect it.
- Use Select All / Deselect All to toggle the whole set.
- The counter in the top-right shows how many photos are currently selected.
- The original alt text appears below each thumbnail as a preview of the title that will be used.

Click Next: Assign & Import to continue. You must select at least one photo.

8.4 Step 3 — Assign Photographer, Club, and Titles

This is where you tell PhotoMatrix who took the photos and optionally group them.

Photographer

Option	When to use
+ Add new photographer	The photographer does not yet exist in PhotoMatrix. Fill in their name and (optionally) a short bio — the bio is pre-filled from text the scanner found on the page; edit it as needed.

Select an existing name	The photographer already has a profile. Their photos will be added to their existing portfolio.

The Import button stays disabled until a photographer name is provided when Add new is selected.

Club

A club is required before you can import. Select an existing club from the list, or choose + Add new club and type the club name. The Import button stays disabled until a club is chosen.

Per-photo Title and Theme

Every selected photo appears in a scrollable list with two editable fields:

Field	Notes
Title	Required. The scanner pre-fills this from the image's alt text. Titles that look like camera filenames (e.g. IMG_20240315_123456.jpg, DSC_0042, PXL_20230901) are automatically cleared and shown with a red border — you must type a real title before importing.
Theme	Optional. Assign the photo to one of the site's themes. Defaults to No theme.

You can scroll through the list and edit titles/themes before clicking Import. All red-bordered fields must be filled in — if you click Import with any title still empty, a toast message will tell you which photo needs a title.

Click *Import N photos* to start. A spinner shows progress; do not close the tab while importing.

8.5 Step 4 — Import Complete

A confirmation screen shows:

- How many photos were imported successfully.
- How many failed (network errors, unsupported formats, etc.).

Click Import More to return to Step 1 and start a new import session.

Photos that fail do not create partial records. You can safely re-scan the same URL and import only the failed ones.

8.6 Tips and Edge Cases

Photographer already exists but their name is slightly different

Choose their existing entry from the dropdown rather than creating a duplicate. You can always edit the photographer's name and bio later from the Photographers tab.

Some photos scanned but are showing as broken thumbnails

The proxy preview in Step 2 fetches images through the server to bypass CORS restrictions. A broken thumbnail usually means the source URL requires a session cookie or referrer header. Those photos will most likely fail to download — deselect them.

File-slug titles were cleared but the scanner found no alt text

This happens on sites that use filenames as alt attributes or that omit alt entirely. Simply type a descriptive title in the red field.

“Download & store” vs “Link only” — which to choose?

Use Download & store unless you are running a storage-constrained pilot or the photographer explicitly wants to keep photos on their own server. Link-only imports are fragile and can leave broken images in the gallery if the source disappears.

Importing the same photo twice

The import does not deduplicate by image URL. If you re-scan and re-import the same URL, you will create duplicate records. Always check whether the photos are already in the gallery before re-importing.

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